A CREATIVE STORY BUILDER · PROJECT GUIDE

Make a world worth seeing.

Vizzy Studio is a collaborative workspace for turning an idea into a graphic novel, visual story, or storyboard—one considered frame at a time.

01 · TALK IT THROUGH	02 · MAKE THE FRAME	03 · PLAY THE STORY
Shape the premise, tone, dialogue, and visual beats with Vizzy, your creative partner.	Set a visual style and palette, then compare two image directions before adding a frame.	Refine frames, reorder the sequence, autoplay a slideshow, or export it as a standalone HTML file.

THE CREATIVE LOOP

01 **Set the direction**
Name the story; choose its look, palette, and premise.

02 **Collaborate with Vizzy**
Use chat to explore the next scene, point of view, or line of dialogue.

03 **Choose & refine**
Generate two treatments, select a favorite, and refine it without losing the story's sequence.

04 **Sequence & share**
Review frames as a slideshow; export a self-contained HTML playback file.

GET STARTED LOCALLY

```
npm install
cp .env.example .env # optional: add an AI key
npm run dev
```

Open the Vite URL printed in the terminal (normally `http://localhost:5173`). The Express API runs at `http://localhost:3001`. On first launch, Vizzy seeds a sample story, "Salt & Signal."

BUILD & OPERATE

A small stack.
A complete story loop.

The MVP keeps the authoring experience quick to run, while leaving a clean path from local demo to an AI-connected server.

WHAT'S UNDER THE HOOD

Frontend
React 19 + Vite 6
Responsive chat, canvas, frame picker, slideshow, and exports.

Backend
Express 5 API
Chat, project, image-option, and frame endpoints; serves the production build.

Persistence
SQLite via Node's built-in `node:sqlite`
Projects, frames, and conversation messages live in `server/vizzy.sqlite`.

AI integration
OpenAI-compatible chat + image APIs
Server-side key handling; sample artwork and assistant replies in demo mode.

AI CONFIGURATION

Copy `.env.example` to `.env`, then set `OPENAI_API_KEY`. Optional settings: `OPENAI_CHAT_MODEL=gpt-4o-mini`, `OPENAI_IMAGE_MODEL=gpt-image-1`, and `OPENAI_BASE_URL=https://api.openai.com/v1`. Without a key, the server uses a local SVG-art fallback and rule-based Vizzy replies.

API QUICK REFERENCE

ROUTE	PURPOSE
`GET /api/projects` `POST /api/projects`	List and create story projects.
`POST /api/projects/:id/messages`	Save a chat message and return Vizzy's response.
`POST /api/projects/:id/options` `POST /api/projects/:id/pages`	Generate two image directions; save the selected frame.
`PATCH /api/pages/:id` `DELETE /api/pages/:id`	Refine or remove a frame in the sequence.

BUILD & DEPLOY

`npm run build` · create production frontend

`npm start` · serve app + API on port 3001

GitHub Pages note. The repository includes a static-demo deployment workflow. Pages must first be enabled in repository settings with "GitHub Actions" as the source. Pages runs a browser-only demo: stories are saved in that browser's local storage; it does not host the Node/SQLite API or enable live AI. For persistent shared data and live AI, deploy the Node server to a host and provide the environment variables there.